

Curriculum Vitae — Seynudé Jean-Fortuné DAGNON, MD, MPH

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Curriculum Vitae

Seynudé Jean-Fortuné DAGNON, MD, MPH

Senior Program Officer — Malaria / Francophone Africa at the Gates Foundation.

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Profile

- Medical doctor with master’s degree in public health option disease control (Institute of Tropical Medicine of Antwerp, BELGIUM).
- Excellent knowledge and full professional proficiency in French (5/5 native language), advanced knowledge of English (4.5/5).
- Relevant experience working for global institutions, including the Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation, the U.S. President’s Malaria Initiative, MCDI, MSH, and URC-CHS.
- Seventeen years of relevant experience in designing, programming, overseeing, managing, implementing, monitoring, and evaluating development and research projects in tropical diseases in the areas of malaria, HIV/AIDS, neglected tropical diseases, outbreaks, and maternal, neonatal and child health in Benin and Africa.
- Strong experience in collaborating with global organizations in the USA, Europe, Asia, and African government entities in anglophone and francophone countries (Benin, Burkina Faso, Senegal, Mali, Côte d’Ivoire, Niger, DRC, Chad, Burundi, Rwanda, Cameroon, Sierra Leone, Liberia, Nigeria, Guinea, etc.).
- Traveled at least 40% of work time during the last three years.
- Strong capacities in portfolio and project management, networking, donor mobilization, budgeting, and financial analysis.
- Good knowledge of epidemiological, qualitative, and quantitative data analysis.
- Relevant experience designing, conducting, and overseeing surveys and evaluations from recipients’ and donors’ perspectives (survey and evaluation protocol design, collection and quality assurance of epidemiological data, design and management of databases in Access or EpiData, and quantitative data analysis).

- Excellent aptitude in communicating with partners in multiple areas (including local and international NGOs, government entities, Ministries of Health, international organizations, civil society, and health facilities).
- Strong knowledge of USAID, Global Fund, and BMGF administrative and financial procedures.
- Excellent skills and experience in proposal writing and assessment.
- Mastery of Microsoft Office: Excel, Word, PowerPoint, Outlook.
- Reviewer for high-impact factor scientific journals, PLOS ONE and BMC.
- 15 peer-reviewed publications in high-impact factor scientific journals.

Professional Experience

Senior Program Officer — Malaria / Francophone Africa

Dec. 2020 — present

Gates Foundation

Designs and leads malaria implementation strategies and performance-based investments; reviews grants and contracts; supports strategy, collaboration, sustainability and field partner engagement.

- Develop, manage, and implement malaria implementation strategies and negotiate complex performance-based investments
- Review letters of inquiry, grant and contract proposals; provide precise, concise written analyses and recommendations
- Manage internal processes, portfolio progress, budgeting, and reporting
- Contribute to the design of new strategies, collaborations, and implementation plans for long-term sustainability
- Maintain high-quality interactions with field partners, grantees, and key stakeholders
- Represent the foundation with public and private stakeholders

Key projects : CRS — LLIN Digitization (Benin · \$3,150,000 (3 yrs)) — CRS — Integrated Platform (Benin · \$2,000,000 (3 yrs)) — MSH — SMC Research (Benin · \$272,000 (2 yrs)) — Zenysis — Interoperability (Benin · \$438,000 (1 yr)) — Muso Inc — Resistance Biomarkers (Mali · \$674,000 (3 yrs)) — Alliance Malaria Prevention (Geneva · \$12,969,000 (3 yrs)) — LSHTM — SMC Efficacy (Burkina Faso · \$1,600,000 (3 yrs)) — PSI — Malaria Market (Benin, Nigeria, Cameroon · \$4,000,000 (3 yrs)) — PATH MACEPA (DRC, Senegal, Gambia, CAR · \$48,000,000) — CHAI Malaria Grant (DRC, Cameroon, Benin, Burkina Faso · \$74,000,000) — ENABEL (Burundi, Niger · \$11,000,000) — Harvard — Science of Defeating Malaria (USA · \$750,000)

Program Management / Malaria Specialist

Nov. 2015 — Nov. 2020

USAID Benin — U.S. President's Malaria Initiative

Leads planning, implementation, coordination and monitoring of malaria programs; supports outbreak preparedness and response; manages G2G mechanisms and partners.

- Responsible for all aspects of malaria programs: planning, organizing, implementing, coordinating, and monitoring for results
- Oversees activities funded through grants, contracts, and cooperative agreements
- Coordinates USAID response to emerging epidemics (Ebola, Lassa fever, COVID-19)
- Oversees implementation of activities to control 7 neglected tropical diseases
- Participates in developing the Malaria Operational Plan (MOP) and Project Appraisal Documents

Key projects : ARM3 (AOR) (Benin · \$21,000,000 (6 yrs)) — DINDJI HIV (AOR) (Benin · \$3,200,000 (3 yrs)) — Ebola (AOR) (Benin · \$600,000 (2 yrs)) — IL 19, 27, 29 (GATR) (PNLP Benin · \$4,000,000 (3 yrs)) — IL 25, 32-34 (GATR) (PNLP Benin · \$4,000,000 (3 yrs)) — IL 24, 26, 31, 33 (GATR) (CREC Benin · \$5,000,000 (3 yrs)) — AIRS (Manager) (Abt Associates · \$4,200,000/yr) — CATCH (Manager) (CRS · \$3,000,000 (3 yrs)) — ENVISION (Manager) (RTI · \$10,000,000 (7 yrs)) — ACT END NTDs (Manager) (FHI 360 · \$10,000,000 (5 yrs))

Negotiated G2G contract with Benin NMCP, generating savings of up to \$3,000,000 over 5 years for the U.S. government.

International Consultant — Monitoring & Evaluation

Oct. — Nov. 2015

MSH / SIAPS, Guinea

Supports M&E activities and the review of Guinea's national strategic malaria control plan.

- Ensure monitoring and evaluation activities within the project
- Support the Guinea Ministry of Health in reviewing their national malaria strategic plan

Monitoring & Evaluation Lead

Nov. 2012 — Sept. 2015

MCDI / ARM3, Benin

Heads M&E systems, surveys, data quality audits, performance-based monitoring and improvement of routine malaria information.

- Supervise field M&E Advisors and database advisor
- Periodic reporting of activities and progress to USAID
- Lead design and implementation of M&E activities for the Consortium
- Provide technical support in implementing the Health Information System
- Participate in survey design and conduct surveys
- Design and implement routine data quality audit processes
- Assure M&E of performance-based approach in all 34 health zones

Increased routine malaria information system completeness from 35% to 94% and decreased error rate from 44% to 5% across 1,114 health facilities.

Maternal, Newborn, Child Health & Immunization Specialist

Nov. 2011 — Oct. 2012

URC / PISAF, Benin

Supports integrated family health activities, malaria IPTp strategy monitoring, immunization analysis and health worker training.

- Ensure monitoring of ETAT strategy (severe malaria in under-five children)
- Train field staff in Health Integrated Interventions including malaria
- Support implementation of family health program integrated activities
- Analyze immunization coverage and identify strategies to increase coverage

Clinical Trials Monitor

Jan. 2008 — Jul. 2010

CERHHUD / AUDOBEM-AFRO

Collects and assures quality of epidemiological data from 15 hospitals; supports clinical audits and emergency obstetric care training.

- Collect and assure quality of epidemiological data from 15 hospitals in all 12 regions of Benin
- Monitor and evaluate implementation of clinical audits in 10 hospitals

- Train health professionals on clinical management of obstetric emergencies
- Train health professionals on use of partographs and near-miss clinical audits
- Periodic analysis of collected data

Education

Ph.D. in Health Economics (in progress)

University of Groningen, Netherlands

Ph.D.

Master of Public Health (MPH)

Institute of Tropical Medicine, Antwerp, Belgium

Master

Doctor of Medicine (MD)

University of Conakry, Guinea

Ph.D.

Languages

French (native), English (advanced professional), some German and Spanish.

Teaching

- 2024 — Institut Régional de Santé Publique, Ouidah, Benin — Lecturer for the National Malariology training for program managers.
- 2020 — IRSP / National program — Training of young logisticians on the Routine Malaria Information System.
- 2014 — Benin — Training of 44 hospital statisticians on the use of the LOGISNIGS software.
- 2013 — Benin — Training of 34 health zones statisticians on LOGISNIGS software.
- 2013 — Benin — Training of health workers in malaria management (diagnosis and treatment).
- 2011–2012 — Zou-Collines region, Benin — Training of health workers on integrated family health strategies: family planning, HIV/AIDS, and malaria.
- 2008–2010 — Benin — Training of health workers on the implementation of clinical audit.

Further Training & Certificates

June 2023 — Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health — Certificate in Science of Defeating Malaria, a leadership course.

From October 2018 to now — University of Groningen, Netherlands — Ph.D. in health economics (underway), external student enrolled in a distance program. Thesis: Cost-effectiveness of Indoor Residual Spraying in reducing the malaria burden in Northern Benin, West Africa.

October 2020 — University of Abomey-Calavi, Beninese Centre of Foreign Languages (CE.BE.LA.E. – UAC) — Certificate of Knowledge in English Language level B2 of CECR (TEFL B2).

March to May 2020 — Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health — Defeating Malaria from the Gene to the Globe.

August 2019 — USAID University, Bangkok, Thailand — Enhanced Agreement/Contracting Officer Representative (AOR/COR) training.

November 2017 — USAID University, Washington, D.C. — Project Design and Management.

May 2017 — USAID University, Harare, Zimbabwe — Environmental Compliance, Sound Design in the Project, and Management in Project Implementation.

November 2016 — USAID University, Washington, D.C., USA — Global Acquisition and Assistance System (GLAAS) training.

September 2016 — USAID University, Washington, D.C., USA — Agreement/Contracting Officer Representative (AOR/COR) training.

August 2016 — USAID University, Accra, Ghana — Advanced English Writing Proficiency.

January 2016 — USAID University, Accra, Ghana — Programming Foreign Assistance with the US Government.

December 2015 — USAID University — Gender 101: Gender Equality at USAID.

October 2012 — USAID and Johns Hopkins Bloomberg School of Public Health — Certificate of course completion “Data Use for Program Manager” and “Monitoring and Evaluation Fundamentals”.

July 2011 — Prince Leopold Institute of Tropical Medicine – Antwerp, Belgium — Master’s in Public Health (Option Reproductive Health).

March 2011 — Clinical Centre, National Institutes of Health (NIH, USA) — Introduction to Principles and Practice of Clinical Research.

March 2011 — Flemish Community, Department of Education, Belgium — Certificate of English Level 2.

September 2009 — IRSS Burkina Faso — Methodology of Research in HIV and Reproductive Health.

April 2009 — Centre Muraz, Burkina-Faso / London School of Hygiene and Tropical Medicine — Stata 9 course.

December 2009 — Centre Beninois de Langues Étrangères (CEBELAE) — Certificate of English Language Skill Level 2.

2001–2007 — University of Conakry, Guinea — Doctorate in General Medicine.

Scientific Work

Reviewer for high-impact factor journals : PLOS ONE, BMC

- Willingness to Pay for Health Insurance in the Informal Sector of Sierra Leone (PONE-D-16-46355) — PLOS ONE
- Porous safety net: catastrophic health expenditure and its determinants among insured households in Togo — BMC
- Effects of Geographic and Economic Heterogeneity on the Burden of Rotavirus Diarrhea and the Impact and Cost-Effectiveness of Vaccination in Nigeria — PLOS ONE

Scientific Community Membership

- Since 2016 — Member of the American Society of Tropical Medicine and Hygiene (ASTMH)
- Since 2012 — Member of the Malaria Core Group, Washington DC
- Since 2011 — Member of the International Health Economics Association (IHEA)
- 2009–2011 — Member of the International AIDS Society (IAS)
- 2023 — Member of the scientific committee of the Multilateral Initiative on Malaria (MIM) conference

Awards & Honors

2025 Special Award — Commitment to Malaria Elimination in Africa

Iconé 360 NGO and its partners, in collaboration with Expertise France, presented Dr. Dagnon with a special award in recognition of his commitment and work in the fight against malaria in Benin and across Africa.

2022 LOVE Machine Award

For representing the Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation at the opening session of the 2022 PAMCA Conference in Kigali, Rwanda.

2020 FSN Employee of the Year

The most prestigious distinction given by the U.S. President's Malaria Initiative for its staff based in 27 countries worldwide.

2020 Meritorious Honor Award

For exceptional professionalism, diplomacy, and extraordinary resilience and dedication to service that resulted in the continuity of essential malaria services during extremely difficult conditions of the COVID-19 pandemic.

2020 Eagle Award

For outstanding technical and programmatic leadership throughout the malaria Operational Planning process in 2019.

2019 U.S. Government LES of the Year

The most prestigious distinction given by the U.S. Department of State to Foreign Service Nationals working in the U.S. administration, for outstanding sustained performance in overseeing, expanding, and leading the PMI program in Benin (2016–2018). Building on this recognition, Dr. Dagnon has continued to extend his impact across the African continent.

2017 On-the-Spot Cash Award

For preparing and coordinating the submission of 9 scientific abstracts on malaria for PMI Benin for the ASTMH conference.

2017 Eagle Award — U.S. Embassy Cotonou

For organizing the visit of PMI Deputy Director Bernard Nahlen.

2007 Laureate of Annual Scientific Presentation Competition

University of Conakry — Topic: determinants of obesity.

Publications (selection)

Rose Leke, Seynude Jean Fortune Dagnon (2026). From Malaria Control to Elimination: The Turn We Need to Make. Africa Health Watch — Perspectives. africahealthwatch.com/p/from-malaria-control-to-elimination?utm_source=publication-search

Morlino C., Byrne I., Achan J., ... Dagnon S.J.F., ... Cohee L.M. (2025). Barriers to uptake and implementation of malaria chemoprevention in school-aged children. *Frontiers in Tropical Diseases*. 10.3389/fitd.2025.1480907

Souza Svigel S., Adeothy A., Kpemasse A., ... Dagnon F., ... Lucchi N.W. (2021). Low prevalence of highly sulfadoxine-resistant dihydropteroate synthase alleles in Benin. *Malaria Journal*. 10.1186/s12936-021-03605-5

Ahogni I.B., Salako A.S., Dagnon J.F., ... Akogbeto M.C. (2020). Assessment of the Durability and Bio-effectiveness of Three Long-Lasting Insecticidal Nets in Benin. *Journal of Biology and Life Science*. 10.5296/jbls.v11i2.17645

Ahogni I.B., Aikpon R.Y., Dagnon J.F., ... Akogbéto M.C. (2020). Chemical barrier and survivorship: Comparative study of two brands of polyester nets in Benin. *International Journal of Mosquito Research*.

Sominahouin A., Dagnon F., Padonou G.G., Akogbéto M.C. (2020). Malaria Risks Related to Poor Practices in The Use of Mosquito Bite Control Tools. Preprint — Research Square. 10.21203/rs.3.rs-38144/v1

Sominahouin A., Padonou G.G., Landéhou R., ... Dagnon F., ... Akogbéto M. (2020). Influence of Climatic Factors on Aggression and Infectivity of Anopheles in IRS Districts in Northern Benin. American Journal of Laboratory Medicine. 10.11648/j.ajlm.20200501.11

Akogbéto M.C., Dagnon F., Aïkpon R., ... Padonou G.G. (2020). Lessons learned, challenges, and outlooks for decision-making after a decade of IRS monitoring in Benin. Malaria Journal. malariajournal.biomedcentral.com/articles/10.1186/s12936-020-3131-1

Aïkpon R.Y., Padonou G., Dagnon F., ... Akogbéto M. (2020). Increase in malaria transmission after indoor residual spraying withdrawal in Benin. Malaria Journal. 10.1186/s12936-019-3086-2

Ahogni B., Aïkpon R.Y., Ossè R.A., Dagnon J.F., ... Akogbéto M.C. (2020). Field durability of Yorkool® nets in Benin. Advances in Entomology. scirp.org/journal/ae

Salako A.S., Dagnon F., Sovi A., ... Akogbéto M.C. (2019). Efficacy of Actellic 300 CS indoor residual spraying in northern Benin. Parasites & Vectors. 10.1186/s13071-019-3865-1

Salako A.S., Ossè R., Padonou G.G., Dagnon F., ... Akogbéto M.C. (2019). Population dynamics of Anopheles gambiae s.l. before IRS campaign in northern Benin. Vector-Borne and Zoonotic Diseases. 10.1089/vbz.2018.2409

Sominahouin A., Padonou G.G., Landéhou R., ... Dagnon F., ... Akogbéto M.C. (2019). Influence of climatic factors on Anopheles aggression in northern Benin. Preprint — Research Square. 10.21203/rs.2.14494/v1

Salako A.S., Ahogni I., Aïkpon R., ... Dagnon F., ... Akogbéto M.C. (2018). Insecticide resistance status of Anopheles gambiae in two regions of northern Benin. Parasites & Vectors. 10.1186/s13071-018-3180-2

Akogbéto M.C., Salako A.S., Dagnon F., ... Sezonlin M. (2018). Feeding behaviour comparison of Anopheles coluzzii and Anopheles gambiae in northern Benin. Malaria Journal. 10.1186/s12936-018-2452-9

Aïkpon R., Ossè R., Ahogni I., Dagnon F., Lyikirenga L., Akogbéto M. (2018). Assessment of residual malaria transmission in the Atacora region of Benin. Journal of Entomology and Zoology Studies.

Salako A.S., Ahogni I., Kpanou C., ... Dagnon F., ... Akogbéto M.C. (2018). Entomological baseline data on malaria transmission in northern Benin. Malaria Journal. 10.1186/s12936-018-2507-y

References available upon request.

Contact

Together, let’s accelerate malaria elimination.

Program partnerships, conferences, technical advice or exchanges on health systems in francophone Africa — Dr. Dagnon can be reached via his professional networks.

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